

Panasonic Automotive secures open source compliance

Panasonic Automotive Systems Co., Ltd, has achieved conformance with ISO/IEC 5230 (OpenChain), the international standard for open source software (OSS) licence compliance, strengthening its position as a supply-chain-ready open source leader in automotive software.

ISO/IEC 5230 defines management methods to ensure reliability, transparency, and compliance in the use of open source software across organisations and global supply chains. The standard was established by the OpenChain Project, led by the Linux Foundation, a US-based non-profit organisation.

To support this effort, Panasonic Automotive Systems established an internal Open Source Program Office (OSPO) in April 2025. The OSPO ensures thorough OSS compliance, supports developers using open source, and strengthens contributions to the global OSS community. During the certification process, the company structured OSS utilisation processes, built a highly secure management system, and improved the reliability of OSS usage and related products.

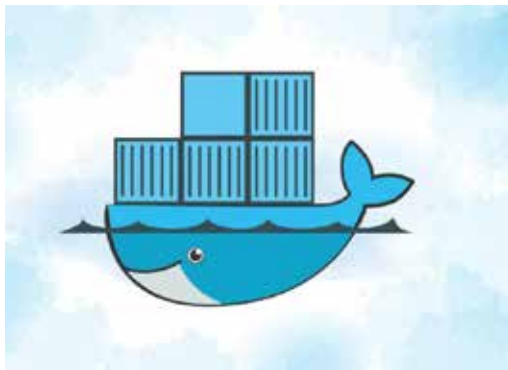
The certification comes as the automotive industry shifts rapidly towards software-defined vehicles (SDVs), where development is increasingly software-centric and OSS plays a critical role in shortening development cycles and reducing costs.

Panasonic Automotive Systems has also contributed to OSS and industry standardisation by promoting VirtIO, an open source virtualisation technology, and open sourcing Unified HMI, a VirtIO-based display virtualisation technology.

The company stated that it would use this certification to deliver high-quality, reliable OSS-based solutions and support the sustainable growth of the open source ecosystem in the in-vehicle device industry.

1000+ Docker Hardened Images now available for free

Docker has made more than 1000 Docker Hardened Images (DHI) fully open source and available for free, marking a decisive shift from a commercial-only model to an open standard for container security. Released under the Apache 2.0 licence, the



images are now subscription-free and accessible to all 26 million-plus developers in the global container ecosystem.

Announcing the move, Docker said: “Today, we are establishing a new industry standard by making DHI freely available and open source to everyone who builds software. All 26 million+ developers in the container ecosystem.”

Docker further emphasised the absence of licensing barriers, stating: “DHI is fully open and free to use, share, and build on with no licensing surprises, backed by an Apache 2.0 license. DHI now gives the world a secure, minimal, production-ready foundation from the very first pull.”

First launched in May 2025 as a commercial offering, Docker Hardened Images are secure, minimal, production-ready base images maintained directly by Docker. They are designed to reduce attack surface and mitigate supply-chain risk at the container layer, serving as hardened foundations rather than application images.

Technically, DHIs are rootless by default, stripped of unnecessary components, and free of known vulnerabilities at release. They support the Vulnerability Exploitability eXchange (VEX) standard and remain SBOM-verifiable, built with SLSA Build Level 3 provenance, and accompanied by proof of authenticity.

Google opens access to its Gemini Deep Research Agent

Google has opened access to its Gemini Deep Research Agent for the first time, allowing developers to integrate advanced autonomous research capabilities directly into their applications. Powering the upgraded agent is the Gemini 3 Pro model, which Google says delivers a significant leap in reasoning depth, autonomy, and reliability.

Designed to operate like a human researcher, the Deep Research Agent performs multi-step web searches, refines follow-up questions, validates sources, identifies information gaps, and continues searching until a complete conclusion is reached. Google states this approach produces deeper and more reliable insights than traditional single-prompt, single-response AI systems.

A key announcement accompanying the launch is DeepSearchQA, an open source benchmark created to evaluate how well AI systems handle complex, multi-step reasoning. The benchmark includes 900 tasks across 17 subjects, including climate, history, and health. Each task builds on the previous one, enabling assessment of an AI system’s ability to maintain logic, consistency, and accuracy across extended reasoning chains. Google positions DeepSearchQA as a shared, open standard to push industry-wide progress in advanced AI reasoning.

Developers also gain access to new capabilities through the Deep Research API, including document parsing, structured report templates, and detailed source citations, designed for easy integration into existing workflows.